LEX-CNF · PRÁCTICA 03

Confusables y palabras sueltas de nivel C2

Hoja 03 · Nivel de examen

Part 1: 8 ítems (1–8) · Part 4: 6 ítems (25–30) · 20 puntos · tiempo orientativo: 25 minutos · sin consultar la teoría

Formato real del examen. En esta hoja, las cuatro opciones de cada hueco de la Part 1 son, casi siempre, un grupo de confusables de la teoría; en el examen se mezclan con collocations, idioms y phrasal verbs.

Part 1 · Multiple-choice cloze

For questions 1–8, read the text below and decide which answer (A, B, C or D) best fits each gap. There is an example at the beginning (0). Mark your answers on the answer sheet.

Example:

0	**A** invincible	**B** insuperable	**C** inexorable	**D** irresistible

The answer is **C** (inexorable).

The market that refused to die

For most of the twentieth century, Hartley's covered market was the beating heart of the town. Like many such markets, however, it had been in **(0)** _____ decline for decades, and by 2015 the number of traders had **(1)** _____ to a handful. That spring, the council announced that the building would be sold to developers.

The decision provoked fury. The council leader insisted that hardly anyone used the market any more – a claim that was soon conclusively **(2)** _____ by the market's own figures, which showed that footfall had actually risen over the previous two years. When protesters occupied the building, the police struggled for two days to **(3)** _____ the riot that followed.

Then, at the eleventh hour, the market won a **(4)** _____ from closure. A local businessman offered to buy the building and lease it to the traders at a nominal rent, dismissing the council's regeneration plan as 'a **(5)** _____ instrument that would destroy the very town centre it was meant to revive'.

Since then he has **(6)** _____ the market's website, which had barely changed since it was first launched, introduced late opening on Fridays and moved quickly to **(7)** _____ suspicions that he intends to sell the site for flats. The scheme has even helped to **(8)** _____ the tide of closures that has swept through the town's high street.

1	**A** dwindled	**B** waned	**C** ebbed	**D** abated
2	**A** denied	**B** retracted	**C** refuted	**D** repudiated
3	**A** muffle	**B** inflame	**C** smother	**D** quell
4	**A** lull	**B** reprieve	**C** truce	**D** hiatus
5	**A** frank	**B** candid	**C** blunt	**D** brusque
6	**A** refurbished	**B** renovated	**C** restored	**D** revamped
7	**A** exacerbate	**B** allay	**C** mitigate	**D** placate
8	**A** stem	**B** curb	**C** restrain	**D** contain

Part 4 · Key word transformations

For questions 25–30, complete the second sentence so that it has a similar meaning to the first sentence, using the word given. **Do not change the word given.** You must use between **three** and **eight** words, including the word given. Here is an example (0).

Example:

0 Nobody noticed the error for years.

UNNOTICED

The error went unnoticed for years.

The gap can be filled by the words 'went unnoticed for', so you write:

0 WENT UNNOTICED FOR

Write only the missing words IN CAPITAL LETTERS.

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25 By cutting back on safety inspections, the airline is running a serious risk of disaster.

COURTING

The airline _____ safety inspections.

26 The players were thrilled to win the cup, but also a little disappointed with their performance.

TEMPERED

The players' delight at winning the cup _____ with their performance.

27 Our new manager has a tendency to make sweeping statements without checking the facts.

GIVEN

Our new manager _____ sweeping statements without checking the facts.

28 Tom and his brother have not been on speaking terms since their mother died.

ESTRANGED

Tom _____ brother since their mother died.

29 The way you handled the press conference reflects very well on you.

CREDIT

The way you handled the press conference _____.

30 She dealt with the complaint very diplomatically.

TACT

She showed _____ the complaint.

Hoja de respuestas · Part 1

Escribe la letra elegida (A, B, C o D). Al corregir, marca 1 punto por acierto; una respuesta doble vale 0.

Nº	Respuesta (A–D)	Punto
1		/ 1
2		/ 1
3		/ 1
4		/ 1
5		/ 1
6		/ 1
7		/ 1
8		/ 1
Total		**/ 8**

Hoja de respuestas · Part 4

Nº	Respuesta (en mayúsculas)	Puntos
25		/ 2
26		/ 2
27		/ 2
28		/ 2
29		/ 2
30		/ 2
	Total	/ 12
Total de la hoja		**/ 20**

SOLUCIONES

Part 1 · Multiple-choice cloze

1 punto por acierto. Cada solución explica por qué es correcta la clave y por qué falla cada distractor, y remite al apartado de LEX-CNF_Teoria_v1 (o de la teoría donde está explicado).

Nº	Clave	Grupo o expresión	Teoría
1	A · dwindled	dwindle / wane / ebb / abate	§6.5
2	C · refuted	deny / refute / rebut / repudiate	§10.2
3	D · quell	muffle / stifle / smother / quell	§9.3
4	B · reprieve	lull / respite / reprieve / hiatus	§6.2
5	C · blunt	frank / candid / blunt / brusque	§3.3
6	D · revamped	refurbish / renovate / restore / revamp	§7.4
7	B · allay	alleviate / mitigate / assuage / allay	§9.1
8	A · stem	curb / stem / restrain / contain	§9.4

1 · A dwindled

Por qué: dwindle to: menguar poco a poco hasta quedar en una cantidad. Se dice de números y cantidades, y to a handful lo confirma.

B waned: wane se dice de cualidades abstractas (el interés, la influencia) y no se construye con to + cantidad.

C ebbed: ebb es retroceder como la marea (la confianza, las fuerzas: ebb away); no *ebb to a handful.

D abated: abate es amainar (una tormenta, una polémica); no se dice de un número de personas.

Teoría: §6.5 dwindle / wane / ebb / abate

2 · C refuted

Por qué: refute: demostrar con pruebas que algo es falso. El agente son unas cifras (the market's own figures) y conclusively subraya que hay prueba.

A denied: deny es negar, y lo hace una persona; unas cifras no niegan nada.

B retracted: retract es retirar lo que uno mismo ha dicho; unas cifras no pueden retirar la afirmación de otro.

D repudiated: repudiate es rechazar formalmente y desvincularse; tampoco tiene sentido con unas cifras como agente.

Teoría: §10.2 deny / refute / rebut / repudiate

3 · D quell

Por qué: quell a riot / unrest: sofocar por la fuerza unos disturbios.

A muffle: muffle es amortiguar un sonido.

B inflame: inflame es avivar, encender aún más (§9.2): justo lo contrario de lo que intenta la policía.

C smother: smother es sofocar el fuego cubriéndolo o agobiar con afecto.

Teoría: §9.3 muffle / stifle / smother / quell

4 • B reprieve

Por qué: win a reprieve from closure: salvarse in extremis, de momento, de algo que amenaza. At the eleventh hour lo refuerza, y win es su verbo típico.

A lull: lull es una calma pasajera en algo activo (a lull in the fighting); no se gana ni va con from closure.

C truce: truce es una tregua entre dos partes enfrentadas; no se gana from closure.

D hiatus: hiatus es una interrupción de una actividad; no se gana.

Teoría: §6.2 lull / respite / reprieve / hiatus

5 • C blunt

Por qué: a blunt instrument: literalmente, un objeto contundente; en sentido figurado, una medida tosca que no distingue. Es una combinación fija de blunt.

A frank: frank es «franco, sincero» y se dice de personas o conversaciones.

B candid: candid es «sincero» o, dicho de una foto, «espontánea»; no forma esta combinación.

D brusque: brusque es «seco en el trato», solo de personas y modales.

Teoría: §3.3 frank / candid / blunt / brusque

6 • D revamped

Por qué: revamp a website: renovar, dar un lavado de cara para modernizar (una imagen, una web, un sistema). Had barely changed since it was first launched explica que hacía falta.

A refurbished: refurbish es reacondicionar el interior o el equipamiento de un edificio, no una web.

B renovated: renovate es reformar un edificio.

C restored: restore devuelve algo a su estado original, y la web apenas había cambiado desde su creación: no había nada que restaurar.

Teoría: §7.4 refurbish / renovate / restore / revamp

7 • B allay

Por qué: allay suspicions / fears: disipar sospechas o temores. Moved quickly to indica que él actúa para que desaparezcan.

A exacerbate: exacerbate es agravar (§9.2): justo lo contrario de lo que pretende.

C mitigate: mitigate atenúa efectos o riesgos; no se usa con sospechas.

D placate: placate es aplacar a una persona enfadada (§15): su objeto es una persona, no unas sospechas.

Teoría: §9.1 alleviate / mitigate / assuage / allay

8 • A stem

Por qué: stem the tide / flow: detener un flujo o una oleada, aquí la de cierres.

B curb: curb frena algo excesivo (el gasto, la inflación); no se combina con tide.

C restrain: restrain sujeta a una persona o la refrena.

D contain: contain impide que algo se extienda (un fuego, una epidemia); con tide, la combinación es stem.

Teoría: §9.4 curb / stem / restrain / contain

Part 4 · Key word transformations

Corrige cada ítem por mitades: 1 punto por cada mitad correcta y bien escrita. Se acepta cualquiera de las variantes indicadas; las respuestas fuera de 3–8 palabras o con la palabra clave cambiada valen 0.

25 IS COURTING DISASTER BY CUTTING BACK ON (7 palabras)

También vale: IS [SERIOUSLY / REALLY / POSITIVELY / ACTIVELY] COURTING (DISASTER / CATASTROPHE) (BY / IN / THROUGH) (CUTTING BACK ON / CUTTING DOWN ON / SCALING BACK ON / SKIMPING ON / ECONOMISING ON / MAKING CUTS TO) (6–8) · **IS [SERIOUSLY / REALLY / POSITIVELY / ACTIVELY] COURTING (DISASTER / CATASTROPHE) (BY / IN / THROUGH) (CUTTING / REDUCING / CURTAILING / SCALING BACK)** (5–7) · **IS [SERIOUSLY / REALLY] COURTING (DISASTER / CATASTROPHE) (WITH / THROUGH) ITS CUTS TO** (7–8)

Mitades: is courting disaster | by cutting back on

Por qué: Court disaster: buscarse un desastre, exponerse a él. Es el segundo sentido de court y va sin artículo. El complemento de medio pasa detrás: by cutting back on safety inspections.

No puntúa: *IS COURTING A DISASTER BY CUTTING BACK ON (court disaster va sin artículo); *COURTS DISASTER BY CUTTING BACK ON (no usa la palabra clave tal cual: el ítem vale 0; is running es continuo: is courting).

Teoría: §13 Una palabra, dos significados

26 WAS TEMPERED BY DISAPPOINTMENT (4 palabras)

También vale: WAS TEMPERED (BY / WITH) [A LITTLE / SOME / SLIGHT / MILD / A SLIGHT / A MILD / A CERTAIN / A TOUCH OF / A TINGE OF / A HINT OF / A DEGREE OF / A MEASURE OF / A LITTLE BIT OF] (DISAPPOINTMENT / DISSATISFACTION) (4–8) · **WAS (SLIGHTLY / SOMEWHAT) TEMPERED BY (DISAPPOINTMENT / DISSATISFACTION)** (5) · **WAS TEMPERED SOMEWHAT BY (DISAPPOINTMENT / DISSATISFACTION)** (5) · **WAS TEMPERED BY [THEIR] (FEELING / BEING) [A LITTLE / SLIGHTLY / SOMEWHAT / RATHER] DISAPPOINTED** (5–8)

Mitades: was tempered | by (some) disappointment

Por qué: Be tempered by / with sth: verse atemperado, suavizado por algo. A little disappointed pasa a sustantivo (some disappointment), que with their performance completa. Como tempered ya indica que la alegría solo se atenúa, el cuantificador puede ir o no.

No puntúa: *WAS TEMPERED BY DISAPPOINTED (tras by hace falta un sustantivo (o feeling disappointed)); *WAS TEMPERED FROM DISAPPOINTMENT (la preposición es by o with).

Teoría: §13 Una palabra, dos significados

27 IS GIVEN TO MAKING (4 palabras)

También vale: IS [MUCH / VERY MUCH / RATHER / SOMEWHAT / OFTEN] GIVEN TO MAKING (4–6) · **IS GIVEN TO (ISSUING / COMING OUT WITH)** (4–6)

Mitades: is given to | making

Por qué: Be given to sth / -ing: ser dado a, tener tendencia a. To es preposición, así que va seguido de -ing.

No puntúa: *IS GIVEN TO MAKE (to es preposición: making); *IS GIVEN MAKING (falta to).

Teoría: §13 Una palabra, dos significados

28 HAS BEEN ESTRANGED FROM HIS (5 palabras)

También vale: HAS (BEEN / REMAINED) [COMPLETELY / TOTALLY / ENTIRELY / BITTERLY] ESTRANGED FROM HIS [OWN] (5–7)

Mitades: has been estranged | from his

Por qué: Be estranged from sb: estar distanciado de alguien, no tratarse; recoge not on speaking terms. Con since their mother died hace falta el present perfect, y estranged lleva from.

No puntúa: *IS ESTRANGED FROM HIS (con since hace falta has been); *HAS BEEN ESTRANGED WITH HIS (la preposición es from).

Teoría: §15 Emociones, relaciones y trato

29 DOES YOU GREAT CREDIT (4 palabras)

También vale: DOES YOU (GREAT / MUCH / ENORMOUS / IMMENSE / REAL / CONSIDERABLE / THE GREATEST) CREDIT (4–5) · **REALLY DOES YOU CREDIT** (4) · **DOES YOU (A GREAT DEAL OF / A LOT OF / NOTHING BUT) CREDIT** (5–7) · **DOES (GREAT / MUCH / ENORMOUS / IMMENSE / REAL) CREDIT TO YOU** (5) · **IS (GREATLY / VERY MUCH / MUCH) TO YOUR CREDIT** (5–6) · **IS TO YOUR GREAT CREDIT** (5) · **(REFLECTS / BRINGS) (GREAT / MUCH / ENORMOUS / REAL) CREDIT (ON / UPON) YOU** (5) · **IS A (GREAT / REAL) CREDIT TO YOU** (6) · **REDOUNDS GREATLY TO YOUR CREDIT** (5)

Mitades: does you | great credit

Por qué: Do sb credit: honrar a alguien, hablar bien de él; también be to sb's credit y reflect credit on sb. El intensificador (great, much…) recoge very well: sin él se pierde una mitad.

No puntúa: *DOES YOU CREDIT (pierde la intensidad de very well: falta una mitad); *GIVES YOU GREAT CREDIT (give sb credit es reconocer el mérito de alguien, no que algo te honre).

Teoría: §10.4 give / take / claim credit · do sb credit

30 GREAT TACT IN DEALING WITH (5 palabras)

También vale: (GREAT / CONSIDERABLE / REMARKABLE / REAL / MUCH / ENORMOUS / THE UTMOST / A GREAT DEAL OF / A LOT OF) TACT (IN DEALING WITH / WHEN DEALING WITH / IN HANDLING / WHEN HANDLING / IN RESPONDING TO / IN ADDRESSING) (4–8) · **(GREAT / CONSIDERABLE / REMARKABLE / REAL / MUCH / ENORMOUS / THE UTMOST) TACT IN HER HANDLING OF** (6–7) · **(GREAT / CONSIDERABLE / REMARKABLE / REAL / MUCH / ENORMOUS) TACT IN THE WAY SHE (DEALT WITH / HANDLED)** (7–8)

Mitades: great tact | in dealing with

Por qué: Tact: tacto, diplomacia (adjetivo: tactful, no tactical). Very diplomatically pide un intensificador (great, considerable…), y show tact in -ing enlaza con la queja.

No puntúa: *TACT IN DEALING WITH (pierde la intensidad de very: falta una mitad); *GREAT TACTFULNESS IN DEALING WITH (no usa la palabra clave tal cual: el ítem vale 0).

Teoría: §11 Parónimos